Unit 1

NURSE AND NURSING AS A PROFESSION

RXB13J

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of this chapter, the students will be able to,

1. Gain knowledge about history of nursing.
2. Know about the concept of health, illness and about hospital.
3. Nursing and the scope of nursing.
4. Know about a nurse, the qualities of a nurse, the functions of a nurse, fundamental rules of nurse and the nurses pledge.

1.1 INTRODUCTION

நோய்நாடி நோய்முதல் நாடி அதுதணிக்கும்
வாய்நாடி வாய்ப்பச் செயல்

Meaning

Let the physician enquire into the (nature of the) disease, its cause and its method of cure and treat it faithfully according to medical rule

Thiruvalluvar

In the past most individuals and societies viewed good health or wellness as the opposite or absence of disease.

Health is highly desirable state for all human being. Health is an individual perception; it has many meaning and views differently to different people (It differs from person to person).

Wellness is the condition in which an individual functions at an optimal level.

Proverbs on Health

Early to bed and early to rise makes a man
- healthy
- wealthy and
- wise

1.2 DEFINITION OF HEALTH

Defining health is a difficult task. There are many definitions of health offered from time to time. Some of the commonly referred definition are as follows.

"Health is a state of complete

- Physical
- Mental
- Social and
- Spiritual

Well-being, not merely the absence of disease or infirmity" -WHO

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